

STAGE TWO • PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY & PERSONAL BRAND

FIRSTS

PARTICIPANT PRE-WORK

A short primer to send before each session, so people arrive oriented

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Participant Pre-Work Handout

Stage Two • Professional Identity & Personal Brand

FOR FACILITATORS

Send the relevant section below 2-3 days before each session. This stage's pre-work matters more than Stage One's — several sessions involve real accounts, devices, and materials, and arriving without them costs real session time.

Before Session 1: Personal Professional Identity

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- No research required. Just be ready to introduce yourself out loud, more than once.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This session is about spoken and written self-presentation. The only real preparation is arriving willing to say things out loud and revise them on the spot.

Before Session 2: Personal Brand Foundations

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Identify one trusted person (a peer, mentor, or colleague) you could genuinely ask for honest reputation feedback this week — you'll reach out to them as part of this session.

WHY THIS MATTERS

FIRST B9 requires a real conversation with a real person outside the session. Having that person already in mind means you can act on it right away instead of stalling on “who should I even ask.”

Before Session 3: Digital Presence & Online Identity

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring a laptop, not just a phone — this session includes live editing of your LinkedIn profile and building a personal website.
- Make sure you know your LinkedIn login before the session starts.
- Wear something you'd genuinely be comfortable using in a professional headshot, in case there's good natural light available.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is the most hands-on session in the entire program. Coming prepared with the right device and login means session time goes to actual building, not troubleshooting access.

Before Session 4: Professional Communication

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Have a recent, real email you've sent accessible to reference and rewrite.
- Bring your phone — you'll record two short videos of yourself during this session.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Both major exercises this session use real, existing material (a real email, your own voice and face on camera) rather than hypothetical examples.

Before Session 5: Professional Visibility

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bookmark or bring to mind one article or post from the past month that genuinely interested you professionally.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Several exercises this session ask you to engage with or share real content — having something already in mind means you're not searching cold during session time.

Before Session 6: Professional Materials

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring your current resume, ideally as an editable document you can revise live.
- Identify one real job listing you're genuinely interested in — you'll tailor materials against it during this session.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This closing session works with real materials against a real target, not generic templates, so the work produced is something you can actually use afterward.